Public Health Colosseum

WhatsApp Bot — User Guide

Find public-health jobs, internships, scholarships and more, right in WhatsApp

Getting started

Every command starts with a full stop (`.`). Type it in the group, or in a private chat with the bot, and send it like a normal message.

Type this	What it does
`.menu`	The main menu
`.help`	Every command, in a list
`.help scholarships`	How one command works, with examples
`.start`	A quick introduction
`.about`	About the Colosseum
`.ping`	Check the bot is awake
`.sources`	Which websites the bot searches

Tip: capital letters don't matter. `.Job`, `.JOB` and `.job` all work.

Finding opportunities

Add keywords and a place after any search command. Places can be a town, county, country or "remote", and you can name several: `.job public health nairobi, kisumu`.

Type this	What it does
`.job` *keywords*	Jobs by keyword. e.g. `.job community health Kisumu`
`.jobs` *place / type / today*	Jobs by place, type or how recent. e.g. `.jobs Nairobi`, `.jobs remote`, `.jobs today`
`.scholarships`	Scholarships and tuition funding. e.g. `.scholarships masters public health`
`.internships`	Internships and attachments. e.g. `.internships nutrition nairobi`
`.fellowships`	Fellowships and fellow programmes. e.g. `.fellowships global health`
`.research`	Research posts, PhD and postdoc openings. e.g. `.research epidemiology`
`.grants`	Grants and calls for proposals. e.g. `.grants africa`
`.events`	Events, webinars and summits
`.conferences`	Conferences and calls for abstracts
`.training`	Short courses, workshops and training

The opportunity commands search the bot's job sources *and* the web, using AI to keep only real, open opportunities that Kenyans can apply for. Every result has a link to the real listing.

Moving through results

Results come five at a time.

Type this	What it does
`.next`	The next five results
`.prev`	The previous five
`.details 2`	The full description of result number 2

Opportunity alerts

Turn alerts on and the bot posts new public-health opportunities into the chat by itself, as tidy cards. Each card shows the position, organisation, location, salary, deadline, requirements, a short summary and the link to apply, on the employer's own website whenever possible. It watches more than 80 Kenyan and international job, scholarship, fellowship and volunteering sites.

Type this	What it does
`.alerts on`	Start updates in this chat
`.alerts off`	Stop them
`.alerts`	Status: on or off, sites watched, how many are waiting
`.alerts sites`	The list of websites watched

When updates arrive (Nairobi time):

- **Monday 3:00 AM to Friday 1:00 PM** — a new opportunity every few minutes.
- **Friday 2:00 PM** — the weekly report: everything found that week, grouped by type, with a spreadsheet you can open in Excel or on your phone.
- **Weekends** — rest. Updates return on Monday.

In a group, only group admins can turn alerts on or off. In a private chat with the bot, anyone can turn them on for themselves.

Ask the assistant

`.ask` answers any question, on any subject. Questions about current events are answered from today's web, with the sources listed. It is especially good at career help: CVs, cover letters, interviews, application essays and public-health career paths. Ask it to find something, and it runs a real search.

Type this	What it does
`.ask` *your question*	Ask anything
`.ask how do I write a cover letter for a WASH officer job`	Career and application help
`.ask what does a health records officer do`	Explanations in plain language
`.ask what is the current situation of public health in Kenya`	Current events and news: answered from today's web, with sources
`.ask find me nutrition internships in Kisumu`	Searches for real listings

The assistant never makes up job adverts or links: listings always come from a real search. For your own health, it gives general information only. Please see a clinician for personal care.

For group admins

These work for the group's admins. The bot must be an admin of the group too.

Managing the group

Type this	What it does
`.groupinfo`	The group's details and settings (anyone)
`.add 2547XXXXXXXX`	Add someone (number with country code, no +)
`.kick @member`	Remove someone
`.promote @member` / `.demote @member`	Make or unmake an admin
`.close` / `.open`	Only admins can post / everyone can post
`.lock` / `.unlock`	Only admins / everyone can edit group info
`.welcome on` / `.welcome off`	Greet new members automatically
`.welcome set` *message*	Your own greeting: `{name}` tags the newcomer, `{group}` is the group's name
`.welcome test`	Preview the greeting

Keeping the group clean

Type this	What it does
`.mod`	Overview of the group's rules
`.mod on`	Recommended protection: delete and warn for invite links, adverts and spam
`.mod strict`	The same, and remove members who reach the warning limit
`.mod off`	Switch every rule off
`.mod test` *message*	See what a message would trigger, without deleting anything
`.mod copy`	Copy these rules to the other groups of the community
`.antilink on`	Delete links to other WhatsApp groups and channels (job links still work); `.antilink on all` for every link
`.antilink allow who.int`	Always allow links to a website
`.antipromo on`	Delete adverts, sales pitches and money schemes
`.antispam on`	Delete flooding and the same message posted again and again
`.badword add` *word*	Ban a word or phrase; `.badword on` to enforce, `.badword list` to see them
`.silence @member 2h`	Delete everything a member posts for a while (30m, 2h, 1d)
`.unsilence @member` / `.silenced`	Lift a silence / see who is silenced
`.warn @member` *reason*	Give a warning
`.warnings @member` / `.resetwarns @member`	See / clear a member's warnings
`.warnlimit 3`	Warnings before removal (for `remove` rules)

Each rule can be set to `warn` (warn only), `on` (delete and warn) or `remove` (delete, warn and remove at the warning limit). Group admins are never moderated.

For platform administrators

Only the numbers set up as administrators of the bot can use these.

Type this	What it does
`.scan`	Check every opportunity website right now and report what was found
`.pushall`	Send everything waiting into this chat at once, as a list and a spreadsheet
`.alerts interval 3-5`	How often opportunity cards go out (here every 3 to 5 minutes)
`.alerts pause` / `.alerts resume`	Pause or resume updates in every chat

Questions or problems? Contact your group admins.
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